

JORDAN RIVERA

Backend Java Developer
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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Platform engineer with **10+ years** building resilient document-generation pipelines, layout engines, and developer-facing template systems. Specialised in high-throughput PDF rendering, semantic authoring DSLs, and turning brittle production-ops scripts into typed, snapshot-tested libraries that scale.

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Senior Platform Engineer 2024-Present

Northwind Systems

Led the reusable document-generation platform serving billing, hiring, and reporting flows across 8 product teams. Reduced template maintenance time by 70% by retiring per-team PDF scripts in favour of one canonical engine.

Software Engineer 2021-2024

BrightLeaf Labs

Built backend services and production document rendering pipelines processing 2M+ documents per month. Drove the migration from iText to a custom layout engine, eliminating licensing risk and cutting p99 render latency from 1.4s to 380ms.

Backend Engineer 2019-2021

Helix Print Co

Maintained a high-volume invoice-printing service (15M PDFs/year) and authored the compliance test harness that gated every template change.

PROJECTS

GraphCompose

Java 21, PDFBox, Maven, JMH

Declarative Java PDF layout engine. Semantic DSL, slot-based templates, snapshot testing. Powers production CV / invoice / proposal pipelines for hiring tools and billing systems. (Open source)

Template Studio

Kotlin, Compose Desktop, PDFBox PNG diff

Internal tool for evaluating CV, proposal, and invoice output across 14 design presets. PNG diffing, side-by-side layout, baseline freezing.

LayoutLint

Java 21, JavaParser, Spoon

Static analyser that flags fragile authoring patterns (deeply nested rows, untyped offsets, implicit page breaks) before they ship to production.

ChromeForge

Java, GraphCompose, Pandoc bridge

Editorial-magazine document toolkit built on GraphCompose: cinematic covers, pull quotes, multi-column flow, sidebar callouts.

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science 2021. Distinction. Thesis: Composable layout primitives for deterministic document rendering.

University of Manchester

BSc Software Engineering 2019. First-class honours. Specialisation in compilers and static analysis.

Imperial College London

Oracle Java Certification 2023. Java 17 platform deep-dive: records, sealed types, pattern matching, virtual threads.

Professional track

KEY SKILLS

• Java 21	• Kotlin	• Groovy	• Python
• SQL	• PDFBox	• Apache POI (DOCX/XLSX)	• iText
• PostScript	• ICC colour profiles	• font metrics	• Custom DSL design
• semantic layout trees	• pagination	• snapshot testing	• visual regression
• Maven	• Gradle	• GitHub Actions	• JitPack

• Docker	• JMH benchmarking	• JUnit 5	• AssertJ
• PDFBox-based PNG diff	• layout-graph snapshots	• mutation testing (Pitest)	• Maven Central
• Sonatype OSSRH	• GPG signing	• JitPack	• semantic versioning discipline

ADDITIONAL

Languages: English (Fluent), German (Intermediate), Spanish (Basic)
Work Eligibility: Eligible to work in the UK and the EU
Open Source: Maintainer of GraphCompose. Regular contributor to PDFBox issue triage.
Speaking: JVM Summit 2024, Devovx UK 2025 — both on declarative document layout.

References available upon request.